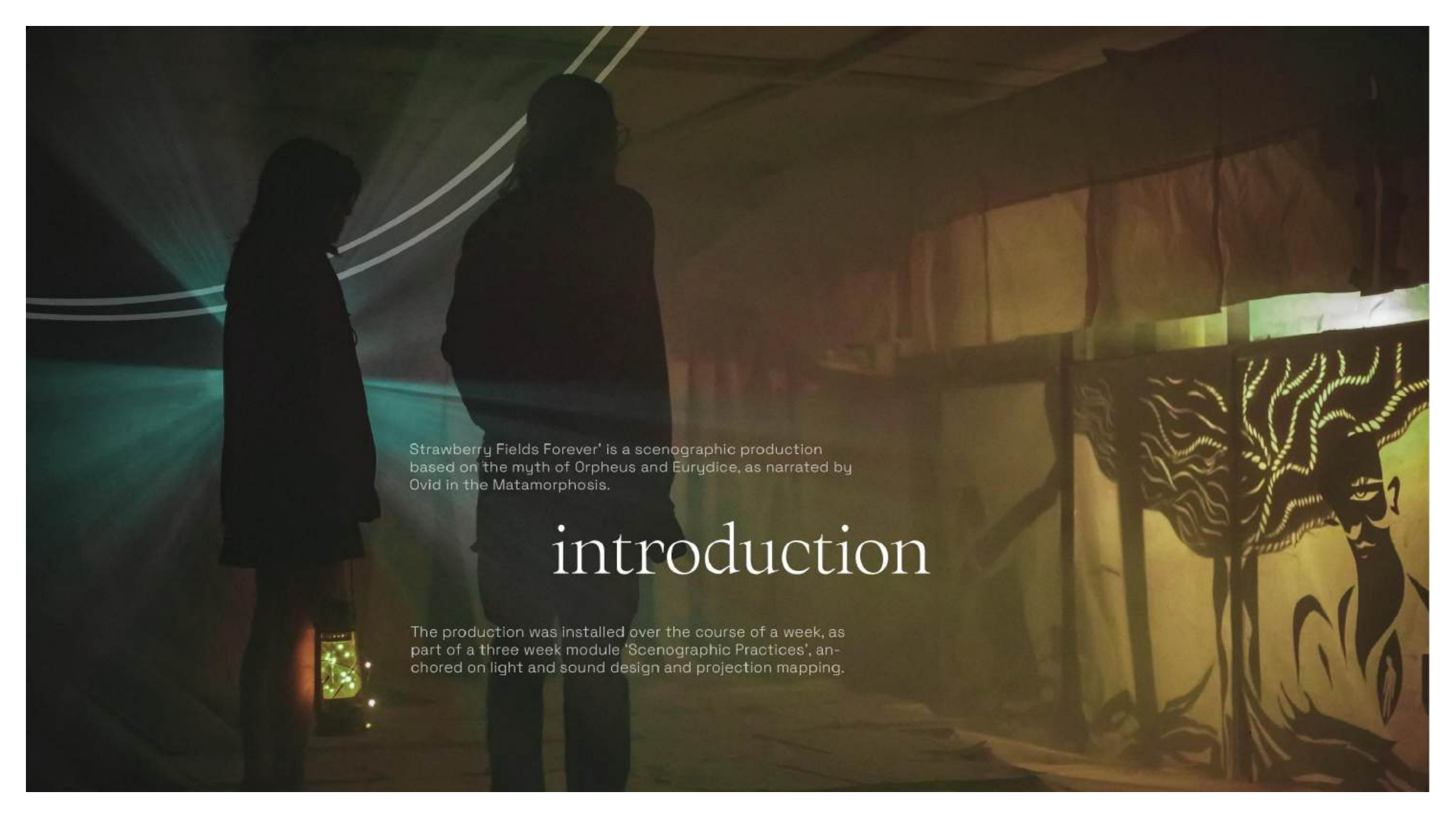


strawberry
fields
forever

Scénography 2023



'Strawberry Fields Forever' is a scenographic production based on the myth of Orpheus and Eurydice, as narrated by Ovid in the Metamorphosis.

introduction

The production was installed over the course of a week, as part of a three week module 'Scenographic Practices', anchored on light and sound design and projection mapping.

A person is holding a lit lantern in a dark, draped environment. The lantern is the primary light source, casting a warm glow on the person's legs and the surrounding fabric. The person is wearing dark clothing and light-colored shoes. The background is a large, wrinkled, light-colored fabric that hangs down, creating a sense of depth and mystery. The overall mood is somber and contemplative.

The tale of Orpheus and Eurydice is as old as time. Our retelling is inspired by a unique interpretation of the story, where Eurydice finds completeness in the land of the dead, while a grieving Orpheus, the participant continues to strive to get her back.

context

the narrative

The experience has been designed as a solo experience, and is centered around the participant who takes on the role of Orpheus, journeying through the Underworld to lead Eurydice back to the land of the living once more.

The walkthrough comprises an audio-narrative of 18 minutes, starting from the foyer, via the elevator and the corridor leading up to the Exhibition Design studio, that signifies an arduous journey to reach the Underworld, where Eurydice now resides.

A woman with long dark hair, wearing a black and white checkered coat, stands in a dark, cave-like environment. She is holding a smartphone that emits a bright blue light, which illuminates her and creates a fan of light rays across the dark background. The overall mood is mysterious and ethereal.

Here I want to live,
I plan to carve a life
No matter the morbid struggles,
no matter the sullen strife
For home is where the heart is,
this you must see
my heart lies here,
in Hell's serenity!

eurydice's voice

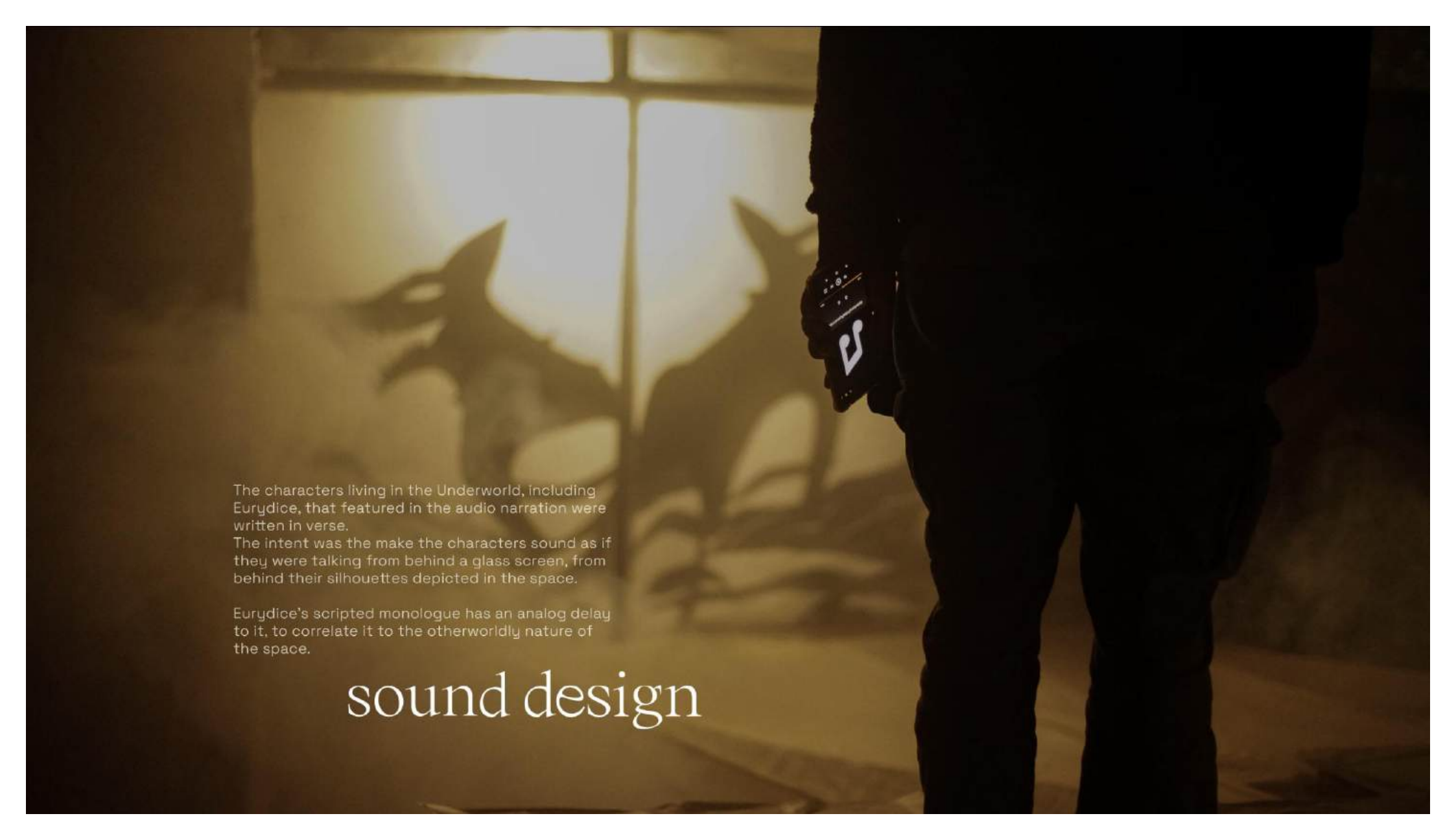
To you my beloved,
a solemn farewell
Don't look back!
I chose here to dwell
I shall now live On my own
where I receive no worry
None in return i shall give!

A close-up photograph of a hand holding a thick, coiled rope. The hand is positioned in the center, with fingers wrapped around the rope. The rope is light-colored and has a textured, braided appearance. The background is a warm, golden-yellow color, possibly a piece of fabric or a wall, with soft lighting that creates a sense of depth and texture. The overall mood is contemplative and symbolic.

The use of various symbols associated with Greek mythology and popular cultural references was employed, such as the Drachma, the lantern and the leash, for the journey undertaken by the participant to be more engaging and theatrical.

symbolism



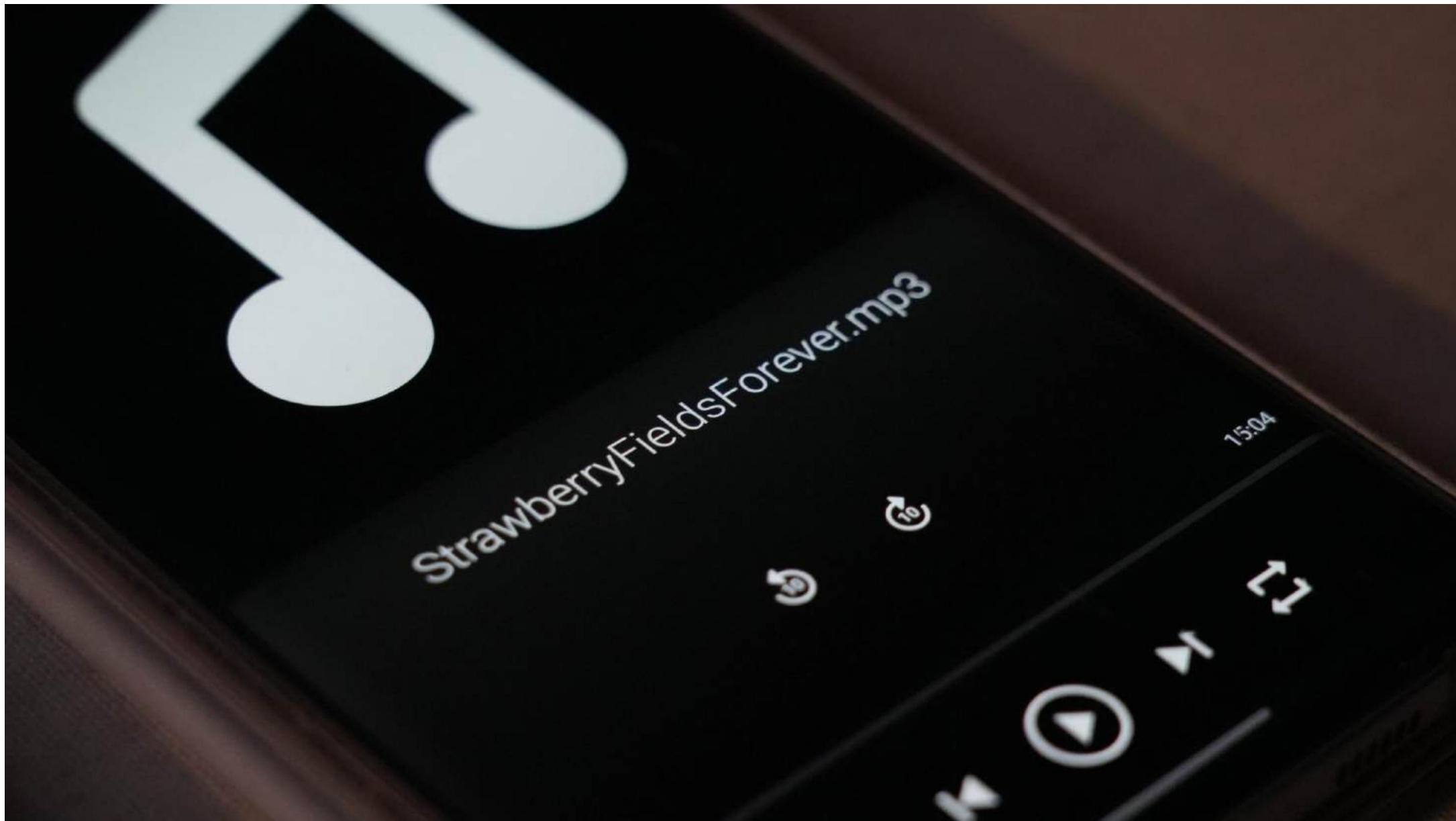


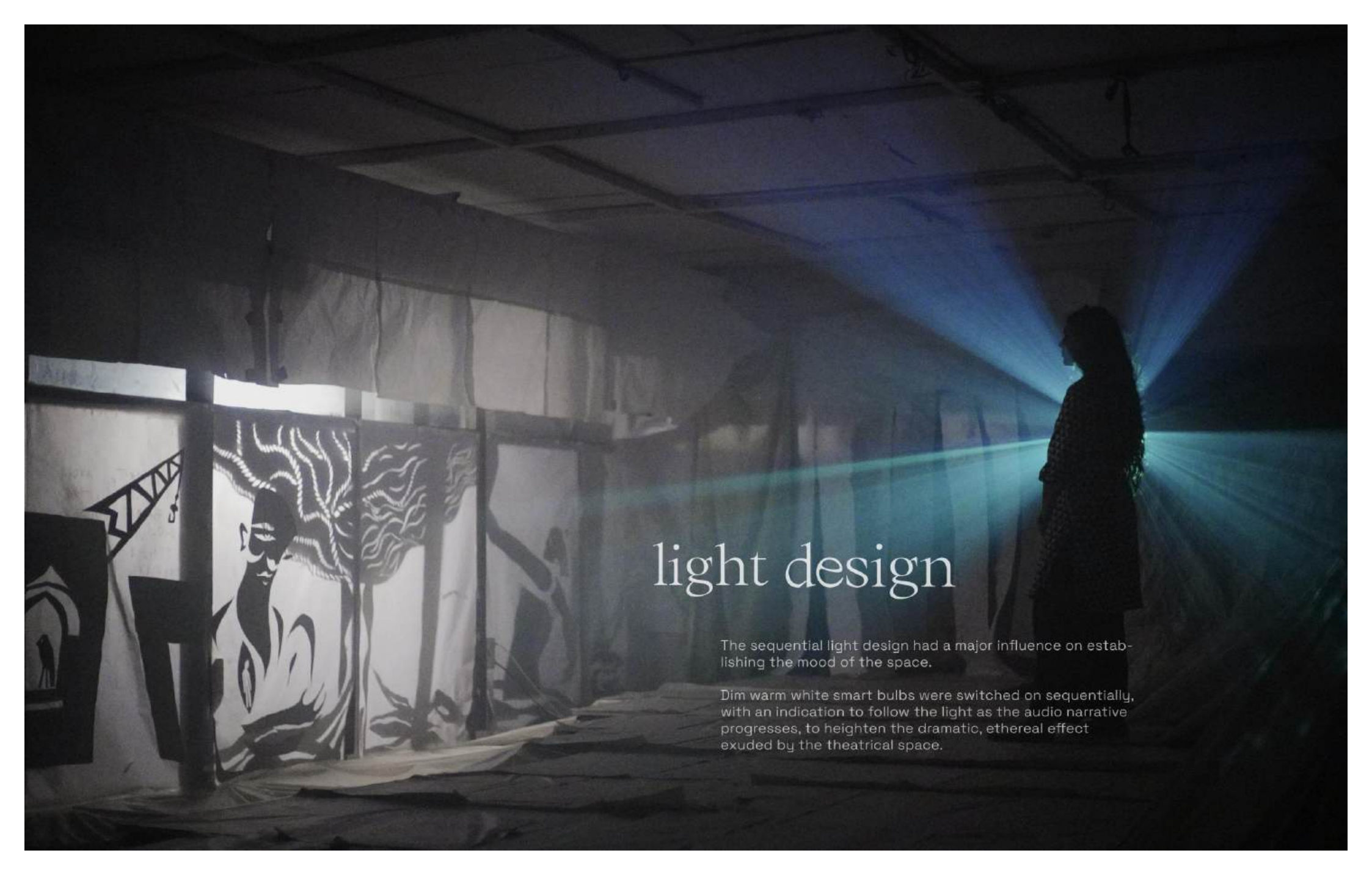
The characters living in the Underworld, including Eurydice, that featured in the audio narration were written in verse.

The intent was to make the characters sound as if they were talking from behind a glass screen, from behind their silhouettes depicted in the space.

Eurydice's scripted monologue has an analog delay to it, to correlate it to the otherworldly nature of the space.

sound design



A photograph of a theatrical stage set. On the left, there are several vertical panels with black and white cutouts of figures and architectural elements. A woman in a dark, patterned dress stands on the right, looking towards the left. She is illuminated by a strong, horizontal blue light beam that cuts through the dark space. Other faint light beams are visible in the background. The ceiling has exposed wooden beams and stage lighting equipment.

light design

The sequential light design had a major influence on establishing the mood of the space.

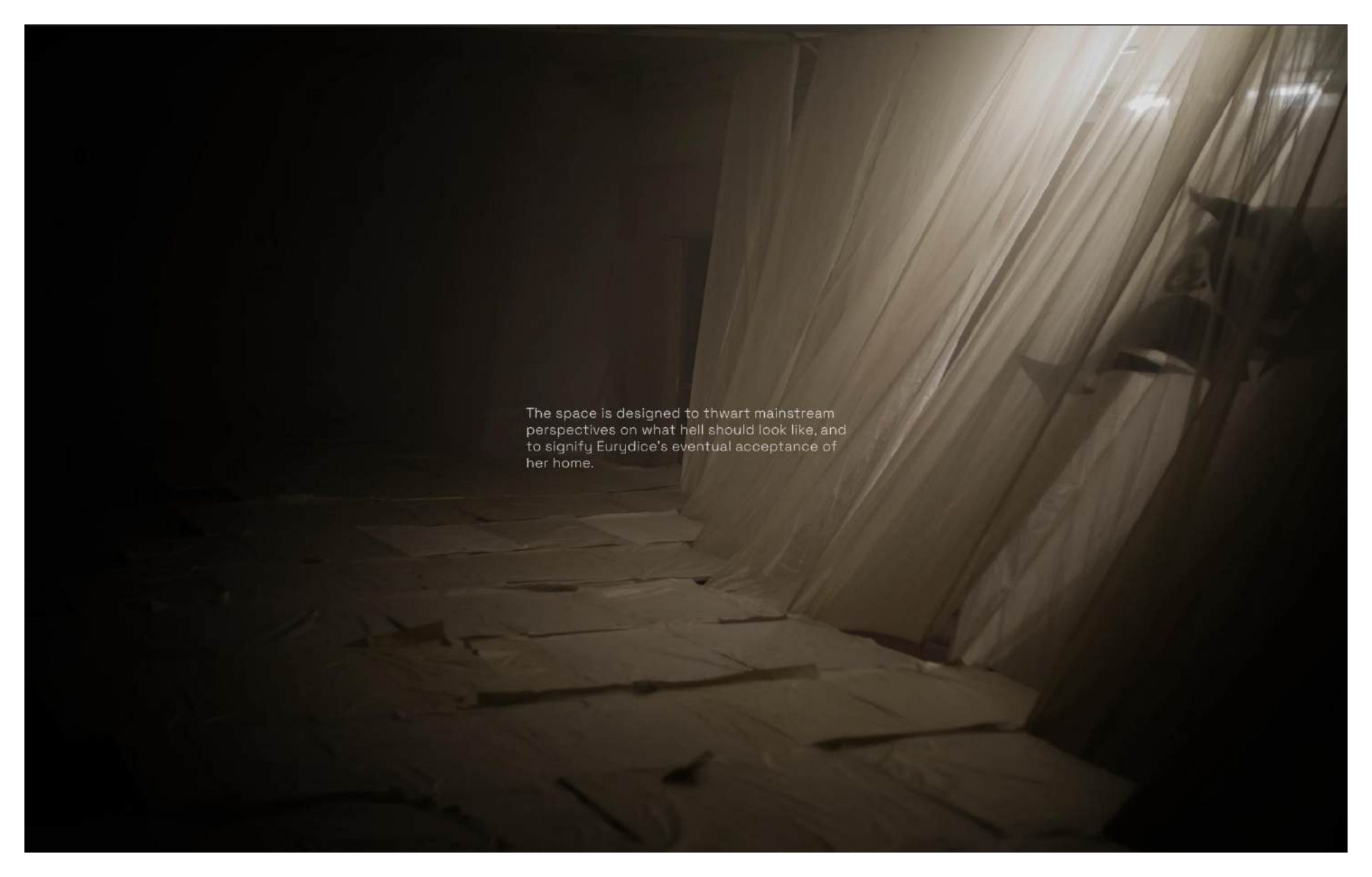
Dim warm white smart bulbs were switched on sequentially, with an indication to follow the light as the audio narrative progresses, to heighten the dramatic, ethereal effect exuded by the theatrical space.





The space chosen for the performance, the Exhibition Design studio, was transformed by way of scenographic installations of paper, cloth and mirrors for suspension of disbelief to occur in the mind of each participant.

space design

The image shows a dark, atmospheric stage set. The floor is covered with a large amount of crumpled, light-colored paper or fabric, creating a textured, uneven surface. On the right side, a translucent, pleated curtain hangs from the top, partially obscuring the background. The lighting is dim, with a few bright spots visible through the curtain, suggesting a window or stage lights. The overall mood is somber and contemplative.

The space is designed to thwart mainstream perspectives on what hell should look like, and to signify Eurydice's eventual acceptance of her home.

THE TEAM



Jai



Arundathi



Anshul



Rik



Mehar



Isal



Sarvagya

strawberry
fields
forever

CREDITS

Faculty Guides

Henny Dörr + Vivek Sheth

Production time

1 week

Venue

Foyer + Exhibition Design Studio
National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad

Dates of Performance

03rd to 04th February 2023

Production Team

Isal Shukla
Arundathi Thillai Rajan
Jai Shrivardhankar
Ritobhash Mukherjee
Anshul Sharma
Mehar Khurana
Sarvagya Kori

Photography and Documentation

Athul Dharani
Akshit Satyanandan
Aadarsh Aryan
Thushar Shivam
Kavyan

Our sincerest gratitude for the support provided by

Faculty

Tanishka Kachru
Shemal Pandya

Student Actors (Messengers of the Underworld)

Karthika Suthan
Vedang Supatkar
Aniket Biju
Sanjivni Bhat
Yash Alva
Amen Shan

Student Volunteers

Harul Vinay
Kanupriya Lohiya
Ananya Mehendale
Tisha Kadam
Ved Waichal
Mayank Bhavsar
Theresa Allapat
Yashansh Singh

Workshop Staff

Munna bhai
Navneet bhai
Devendra bhai
Mahesh kaka
Kanji bhai